

Hundreds, maybe thousands, of people have asked me that same question as I've traveled the country teaching people how to build wealth. I'm talking about people from every walk of life, from well-dressed executives to grocery clerks in checkout lines. They want to know if it's possible for "someone like them" to become a millionaire. Sometimes, they catch a vision for the millionaire life and get to work on a plan to achieve it. Too often, though, people react like Chad, shaking their heads and walking away. They buy into the myths about millionaires that have spread through our society. They think millionaires have some special advantage or were born into money and have had opportunities that aren't available to other people. They believe the headlines that say the rich get richer while the poor get poorer. So, they do nothing, sitting there while fear and apathy take them further and further away from where they want to be.

But then, on the other end of the spectrum, I've had the incredible opportunity to meet thousands of millionaires over the past decade. As I travel for speaking engagements, it seems like millionaires are crawling out of the woodwork across the country. The more millionaires I meet, the more fascinated I become with who they are and what the *average* millionaire looks like. It isn't what I imagined when I was a kid, that's for sure. One day, while I was co-hosting *The Dave Ramsey Show* radio program with my friend Dave Ramsey, we started talking about the idea of "average millionaires." On a whim, we asked the listeners to call in if they had a net worth of \$1 million or more. The phone lines lit up. We knew there were plenty of millionaires out there, of course, but even we were surprised at how many calls we got and how similar their stories were. We decided on the spot to make the Millionaire Theme Hour a recurring part of the show.

So, on one hand, I was faced with an endless stream of people who doubted they could become millionaires. On the other hand, I kept meeting more and more millionaires. I started to ask myself, *If becoming a millionaire is as difficult as some people think, why do I keep meeting millionaires everywhere I go?* That question got stuck like a splinter in my brain. I just couldn't escape it. Over time, I developed a passion to understand what makes the average American millionaire different from everyone else, and that passion led me into a massive research project resulting in this book.